What We Said vs. What Happened

Project _____

Every project starts on claims: that a need is real, that a plan fits the time, that the first version will prove something. A retrospective, at work or on any project, checks those claims against what actually happened. Copy each claim from what you **wrote at the time**, not from memory, then point at the evidence. A claim that held, shown with evidence, was a good call. A claim that didn't, written down with what you learned, is discovery working. Neither is the better answer.

1 · The need *From your problem statement and proposal: who has the problem, and is it real?*

WHAT WE CLAIMED	WHAT HAPPENED: THE EVIDENCE	VERDICT	WHAT WE LEARNED / WHY IT HELD
The user, and the need		☐ held ☐ refuted ☐ open	
How we'd reach them		☐ held ☐ refuted ☐ open	

2 · The plan *From your proposal: did the scope fit the hours that existed? Which named risk fired?*

The scope, against the time		☐ held ☐ refuted ☐ open	
The risk we named first		☐ held ☐ refuted ☐ open	

3 · The build *From your first-version plan: the claims it was built to prove, in your ranked order*

Top-ranked claim		☐ held ☐ refuted ☐ open	
Second claim		☐ held ☐ refuted ☐ open	
Third claim		☐ held ☐ refuted ☐ open	

4 · The cuts *What you deliberately didn't build, and whether each cut was the right call*

The cut		☐ right call ☐ wrong call ☐ can't tell	
The cut		☐ right call ☐ wrong call ☐ can't tell	

The evidence rule: every *held* or *refuted* points at something a reader could check: a demo moment, a line on an audit or test sheet, an issue or pull request, a conversation with a user. **Open** is an honest answer when you name what would settle it.

Read your verdicts down the column. No mix of verdicts is the right one.
Check that every verdict points at evidence, that every *held* was something that could have failed, and that it says why the call was right. Which row did you most want to skip? That's usually the one worth writing about.

This becomes your retrospective: the strongest rows are "what held and what didn't"; the open ones are "what the first version didn't prove."